Need for Rain Water Harvesting

i) To overcome the situation of inadequacy of water supply.

ii) The most economical way to increase the ground water table.

iii) To replenish the sub soil of the urban area covered with pavements.

iv) To recharge the underground water table at places where the availability of rain water is higher or to overcome the situation of water logging.

v) Rain water harvesting also improves the quality of underground water through a process called dilution.

vi) To get water for irrigation of greenbelts, farms, gardens, etc.

Rain Water Harvesting Techniques

There are two main techniques of rain water harvestings:

1) Storage of rain water on surface for future use.

2) Recharge to ground water.

The storage of rain water on surface is a traditional technique and structures used were underground tanks, ponds, check dams, weirs, etc. Recharge of ground water is a new concept of rain water harvesting and the structures generally used are: Recharge pits filled with boulders, gravels, and coarse-sand, Wells, Trenches etc.

7.5 Environmental Impact Assessment

Every country strives to progress ahead. One aspect of progress is economic development through manufacturing and trading. Every country builds industries which provide employment, serve the consumers needs and help to generate revenue. The dominant pattern of development that humankind has followed in recent decades has brought about large scale changes in the earth systems. We are already feeling the impact of these changes upon our health, livelihoods and safety. On the other hand, the fruits of development are not equally distributed. Some countries and some communities have a high standard of living, while others are not able to meet their basic needs.

Development projects in the past were undertaken without any consideration about their environmental consequences. As a result rivers and lakes have been polluted, air pollution has reached threatening levels and pilling of domestic and industrial wastes has resulted in land degradation. Industrialization and economic growth provided material comforts but at the same time deteriorated the quality of life.

The Objective of EIA

(i) To identify, predict and evaluate the economic, environmental and social impact of development activities

(ii) To provide information on the environmental consequences for decision making and

(iii) To promote environmentally sound and sustainable development through the identification of appropriate alternatives and mitigation measures.

Steps in the EIA Process

The eight steps of the EIA process:

i) **Screening:** First Stage of EIA, which determines whether the proposed project, requires an EIA and if it does, then the level of assessment required.

ii) **Scoping:** This stage identifies the key impacts that should be investigated. This stage also defines the time limit of the study.

iii) **Impact analysis:** This stage of EIA identifies and predicts the likely environmental and

TN_GOVT_XII_Geography_chapter 07.indd 138 1/30/2020 2:23:19 PM